

USTR press release + Reuters

Steel/Aluminum Tariff (25%)

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25% tariff on steel and aluminum imports. Directly affects fastener and tool costs.

Industry analysts estimate that demand for affected product categories decreased by approximately 5% during the event period. Prices rose by approximately 8% as manufacturers passed through cost changes to distributors and end customers. The most affected product categories include fasteners, tools, abrasives.

The event period spans from 2025-03-12 to 2026-03-31.

Industrial supply distributors including Grainger, Fastenal, and MSC Industrial reported varying degrees of impact depending on their product mix and geographic exposure. Companies with diversified supply chains and strong inventory positions were better insulated from the disruption.